

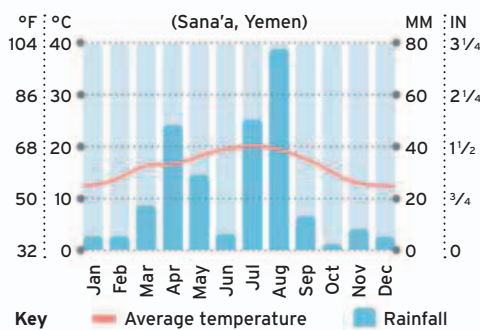
LOCATION

Around the southern edge of the Arabian Peninsula, crossing the United Arab Emirates, Oman, Yemen, and Saudi Arabia.



CLIMATE

The highlands are warm in summer and cool in winter. The highest areas can remain blanketed in fog and dew and have seasonal rainfall.



Hamadryas baboon

Papio hamadryas

doglike muzzle



Full-grown male Hamadryas baboons are among the world's most impressive monkeys, with a muscular build, sharp canine teeth, and a magnificent cape of silvery fur that contrasts with their bright pink faces. Both sexes have pads of bare reddish skin on their buttocks, which swell in females to advertise when they are sexually receptive.

Harems and bands

Hamadryas baboons were well known to the ancient Egyptians, who featured them in religious hieroglyphic carvings and paintings—they are also called sacred baboons. Like other baboon species, they spend most of their time on the ground and forage widely, eating grass, crops, and almost any small animals they find. At night many harems band together and climb cliffs for safety—in some places, a few hundred Hamadryas baboons may sleep on the same rock face.

The big dominant males jealously guard their females from rival males. They use visual threats such as yawning to reveal their large canine teeth and aggressive displays such as neck bites.

- ↔ 20–38 in (51–97 cm)
- ⚖ 20–47 lb (9–21.5 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌿 Grass, fruit, insects
- 🏠



E. Africa,
SW. Asia

Dominant male baboons lip-smack to reassure their females

▽ GROOMING IN PROGRESS

Two female baboons groom a resplendent adult male as an act of loyalty and submission. Each adult male rules over a harem of several smaller, olive-brown females.



KEEPING COOL
Although relatively small compared to other gray wolf subspecies, the Arabian wolf has proportionately larger ears to disperse heat and help keep it cool during hot summers. In winter, its coat thickens to withstand freezing conditions.

ARABIAN WOLF

